

# THE TOXIC HOME CHEAT SHEET

21 everyday products, what is really inside them, and the clean move for each one. Room by room. Keep it on the fridge.

How to use this: find the row that matches something in your house. That is your starting point. You do not need to fix everything this week. Start with one thing.

THE LAUNDRY ROOM **The room almost everyone forgets to check.**

| THE PRODUCT                      | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                            | LINKED TO                                                 | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Laundry detergent                | Detergent makers can list fragrance without naming what is in it, including phthalates, and New York now caps the contaminant 1,4-dioxane in laundry detergents. <sup>[1,2]</sup>               | cancer concerns, hormone disruption                       | Switch your detergent and drop the dryer sheets. Wool balls plus a truly fragrance free American made detergent. |
| Dryer sheets and fabric softener | Fabric softeners and dryer sheets rely on quaternary ammonium compounds, a chemical family that published medical studies link to occupational asthma and respiratory effects. <sup>[3,4]</sup> | occupational asthma, respiratory irritation, skin effects | Switch your detergent and drop the dryer sheets. Wool balls plus a truly fragrance free American made detergent. |
| Free and clear detergent         | Free and clear covers dyes and perfume only; the contaminant 1,4-dioxane never shows on labels, and published testing found it in many household detergents. <sup>[5,6]</sup>                   | possible carcinogen, liver and kidney effects             | Switch your detergent and drop the dryer sheets. Wool balls plus a truly fragrance free American made detergent. |

THE KITCHEN: COOKING AND STORING

| THE PRODUCT                                     | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                  | LINKED TO                                        | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nonstick cookware (PTFE/PFAS coatings)          | Nonstick coatings are made with PFAS, and in 2023 3M agreed to pay up to \$10.3 billion to settle U.S. drinking water PFAS claims. <sup>[7,8]</sup>                   | immune effects, cancer risk, cholesterol         | Cook on ceramic or cast iron. Store in glass. Never microwave plastic. |
| Plastic food containers heated in the microwave | Research shows BPA migrates from plastic into food when containers are heated, and reviews find substitutes like BPS are just as hormonally active. <sup>[9,10]</sup> | hormone disruption, fertility, metabolic effects | Cook on ceramic or cast iron. Store in glass. Never microwave plastic. |
| Canned food linings (BPA epoxy resin)           | Canada's food agency found BPA in 44 percent of canned foods it tested, and the EU adopted a ban on BPA in can coatings in 2024. <sup>[11,12]</sup>                   | hormone disruption, immune effects               | Cook on ceramic or cast iron. Store in glass. Never microwave plastic. |

THE KITCHEN: PANTRY

| THE PRODUCT                                              | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                    | LINKED TO                                                       | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Big-can commodity coffee (ground/roasted)</b>         | Studies of roasted coffee routinely detect ochratoxin A, a mold toxin. A review of 3,182 samples found it in about half; most levels sit under EU limits. <sup>[13,14]</sup>            | kidney harm, possible human carcinogen, immune effects          | Buy tested, mold screened coffee and skip the powders and dyes. Real ingredients, short labels. |
| <b>Antibacterial soaps and body washes</b>               | In 2016 the FDA barred triclosan, triclocarban and 17 other germ killers from consumer antibacterial soaps and body washes. Colgate Total dropped triclosan in 2019. <sup>[15,16]</sup> | thyroid hormone disruption, antibiotic resistance               | Buy tested, mold screened coffee and skip the powders and dyes. Real ingredients, short labels. |
| <b>Boxed mac and cheese and processed cheese powders</b> | Independent lab testing reported in 2017 found phthalates in 29 of 30 cheese products, with the highest levels in boxed mac and cheese powder. <sup>[17,18]</sup>                       | hormone disruption, asthma and eczema, reproductive development | Buy tested, mold screened coffee and skip the powders and dyes. Real ingredients, short labels. |

## THE BATHROOM: HAIR AND BODY

| THE PRODUCT                              | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                                                           | LINKED TO                                             | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                                |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Johnson's baby shampoo (historic)</b> | Johnson's baby shampoo once contained quaternium-15, a preservative that releases formaldehyde, plus trace 1,4-dioxane. After years of public pressure, J&J; reformulated its baby products to remove them. <sup>[19,20]</sup> | formaldehyde exposure, carcinogen traces              | One clean American made brand for hair and body ends the whole guessing game. |
| <b>Adult shampoo and body wash</b>       | FDA says sudsing agents made by ethoxylation, like sodium laureth sulfate, can carry traces of 1,4-dioxane, and phthalates inside "fragrance" do not have to be listed on the label. <sup>[21,22]</sup>                        | anticipated carcinogen traces, undisclosed phthalates | One clean American made brand for hair and body ends the whole guessing game. |
| <b>Dry shampoo and aerosol sprays</b>    | Benzene, a known human carcinogen, turned up in aerosol dry shampoos. P&G; recalled Pantene and Herbal Essences sprays in 2021; Unilever recalled Dove, TRESemme and more in 2022. <sup>[23,24]</sup>                          | leukemia, blood cancers, blood disorders              | One clean American made brand for hair and body ends the whole guessing game. |

## THE BATHROOM: THE REST OF THE SHELF

| THE PRODUCT                                 | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                                   | LINKED TO                                         | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Chemical hair straighteners/relaxers</b> | The FDA has announced plans to ban formaldehyde in hair straighteners, an NIH study linked frequent use to doubled uterine cancer risk, and lawsuits allege relaxers caused cancer. <sup>[25,26]</sup> | uterine cancer, breathing problems, sensitization | If it sprays from a can or promises to be antibacterial, question it first. |
| <b>Antiperspirant aerosols</b>              | In November 2021, P&G; recalled specific Old Spice and Secret aerosol spray antiperspirants after benzene, a known human carcinogen, was detected in the products. <sup>[27]</sup>                     | leukemia, blood cancers, blood disorders          | If it sprays from a can or promises to be antibacterial, question it first. |

| THE PRODUCT                                | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                             | LINKED TO                                          | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Conventional toothpaste (triclosan)</b> | Colgate Total quietly dropped triclosan in 2019 after research raised concerns the antibacterial may disrupt thyroid hormones; the FDA had already banned it from hand soaps. <sup>[28,29]</sup> | possible thyroid disruption, antibiotic resistance | If it sprays from a can or promises to be antibacterial, question it first. |

## THE AIR IN YOUR HOUSE

| THE PRODUCT                                      | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                       | LINKED TO                                                | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Plug-in air fresheners and scented sprays</b> | NRDC lab testing found phthalates in 12 of 14 air fresheners, including Glade PlugIn and Air Wick scented oils, and none listed them on the label. <sup>[30,31]</sup>                      | hormone disruption, breathing trouble, reproductive harm | Nothing that plugs in, sprays, or burns paraffin. Open windows. Clean with quat free cleaners. |
| <b>Paraffin scented candles</b>                  | Peer reviewed chamber testing has measured benzene and formaldehyde in air from burning candles, and candle burning raises fine particle levels indoors. <sup>[32,33]</sup>                | airway irritation, small airway inflammation             | Nothing that plugs in, sprays, or burns paraffin. Open windows. Clean with quat free cleaners. |
| <b>Disinfecting wipes and sprays</b>             | Clorox Disinfecting Wipes list two quaternary ammonium chlorides as active ingredients on the EPA registered label, which carries a CAUTION warning for eye irritation. <sup>[34,35]</sup> | asthma symptoms, eye irritation                          | Nothing that plugs in, sprays, or burns paraffin. Open windows. Clean with quat free cleaners. |

## THE KIDS **The smallest bodies carry the biggest load.**

| THE PRODUCT                                                                     | WHAT IS REALLY IN IT                                                                                                                                                                                                         | LINKED TO                                              | THE CLEAN MOVE                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Red Dye No. 3 in candy, snacks, and children's medicines</b>                 | In January 2025 the FDA pulled Red No. 3 from food and swallowed medicines after studies showed it caused thyroid tumors in male lab rats. <sup>[36,37]</sup>                                                                | thyroid tumors in lab animals                          | Fragrance free everything for kids, dye free treats, and breathable natural bedding. |
| <b>Kids' scented lotions, detanglers, and bubble bath (synthetic fragrance)</b> | A federally funded study of kids ages 4 to 8 found that lotion and hair oil use in the past day tracked with higher phthalate levels in their urine. <sup>[38,39]</sup>                                                      | hormone disruption, developmental effects              | Fragrance free everything for kids, dye free treats, and breathable natural bedding. |
| <b>Crib mattresses and kids' foam mattresses</b>                                | A 2025 University of Toronto study found phthalates and flame retardants coming off children's mattresses into the air, with more released when a mattress was warmed and weighted like a sleeping child. <sup>[40,41]</sup> | childhood asthma, hormone disruption, neurodevelopment | Fragrance free everything for kids, dye free treats, and breathable natural bedding. |

## THE RECEIPTS

*Every claim above is numbered. Here is where each one comes from, so you never have to take my word for it.*

- [1] Consumer Reports: How to Find an Eco-Friendly Laundry Detergent  
<https://www.consumerreports.org/appliances/laundry-detergents/how-to-find-an-eco-friendly-laundry-detergent-a8349611828/>
- [2] NY DEC: 1,4-Dioxane Limits for Household Cleansing Products  
<https://dec.ny.gov/environmental-protection/help-for-businesses/household-personal-cosmetic-dioxane-limits>
- [3] PubMed: Occupational Asthma Caused by Quaternary Ammonium Compounds (multicenter cohort, JACI In Practice 2021)  
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33940212/>
- [4] PubMed: Quaternary Ammonium Compounds, A Chemical Class of Emerging Concern (Environ Sci Technol 2023)  
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37157132/>
- [5] CDC ATSDR: Public Health Statement for 1,4-Dioxane  
<https://www.cdc.gov/TSP/PHS/PHS.aspx?phsid=953&toxid=199>
- [6] PubMed: Determination of 1,4-dioxane in household detergents and cleaners  
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/18476359/>
- [7] EPA: Our Current Understanding of the Human Health and Environmental Risks of PFAS  
<https://www.epa.gov/pfas/our-current-understanding-human-health-and-environmental-risks-pfas>
- [8] ABC News: 3M agrees to \$10.3B settlement over claims it polluted drinking water with 'forever chemicals'  
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- [9] NIH/PMC: The Endocrine Disruptor Bisphenol A (BPA) Exerts a Wide Range of Effects  
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6864600/>
- [10] NIH/PMC (Environmental Health Perspectives): Bisphenol S and F, a Systematic Review of the Hormonal Activity of BPA Substitutes  
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC4492270/>
- [11] Canadian Food Inspection Agency: Bisphenol A and BPA Alternatives in Selected Canned Foods and Infant Formula  
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- [12] European Commission: Commission adopts ban of Bisphenol A in food contact materials (19 December 2024)  
[https://food.ec.europa.eu/food-safety-news/commission-adopts-ban-bisphenol-food-contact-materials-2024-12-19\\_en](https://food.ec.europa.eu/food-safety-news/commission-adopts-ban-bisphenol-food-contact-materials-2024-12-19_en)
- [13] Occurrence of the Ochratoxin A Degradation Product 2'R-Ochratoxin A in Coffee and Other Food: An Update (NIH PMC)  
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6628416/>
- [14] The concentration and prevalence of ochratoxin A in coffee and coffee-based products: a global systematic review and meta-analysis (PubMed)  
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31345415/>
- [15] FDA final rule, Safety and Effectiveness of Consumer Antiseptics (Federal Register, Sept 6 2016, via GovInfo)  
<https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2016-09-06/pdf/2016-21337.pdf>
- [16] Consumer Reports: Are Any Toothpaste Ingredients Dangerous to Your Health?  
<https://www.consumerreports.org/dental-oral-care/are-any-toothpaste-ingredients-dangerous-to-your-health>
- [17] TIME: Most Macaroni and Cheese Products Contain These Chemicals, Study Finds (2017)  
<https://time.com/4858541/mac-and-cheese-phthalates-study/>
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<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/johnson-johnson-to-phase-out-potentially-harmful-chemicals-by-2015/>
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- [22] Phthalates in Cosmetics (FDA)  
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- [27] FDA bulletin: P&G; Issues Voluntary Recall of Specific Old Spice and Secret Aerosol Spray Antiperspirants Due to Detection of Benzene (Nov 2021)  
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- [29] PMC systematic review: The Influence of Triclosan on the Thyroid Hormone System in Humans  
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC9202756/>
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<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC3018511/>
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<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/23695106/>
- [33] Scientific Reports (NIH/PMC): Impact of scented candle use on indoor air quality and airborne microbiome  
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[https://leginfo.ca.gov/faces/billNavClient.xhtml?bill\\_id=202320240AB418](https://leginfo.ca.gov/faces/billNavClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB418)
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<https://www.utoronto.ca/news/u-t-researcher-draws-international-headlines-after-finding-children-s-mattresses-gas-chemicals>

## YOUR NEXT STEP

### Want to know which of these are in YOUR home?

Take the free 3 minute Home Scan. It walks your house room by room and shows you your score.

[scan.ismyhometoxic.com/now](https://scan.ismyhometoxic.com/now)

## LINKS AND MORE

### The free 3 minute Home Scan

<https://scan.ismyhometoxic.com/now/>

### Your First Switch, a free 10 minute call with me

<https://link.switchtoamerica.com/widget/bookings/maketheswtch>

### Switch to America

<https://switchtoamerica.com/>

*From me to you: I went through my own house one room at a time. I am not asking you to throw everything out. Start with one thing, then work down the list. You are not behind, you are just getting started. See you inside the scan. **Shannon Nicole**, Founder*